XYZ Company Leave Policy

Sample document created for assessment purposes only. XYZ Company is fictitious and this policy does not reflect any real organisation.

Policy number	HR-POL-004
Version	2.0
Effective date	1 January 2026
Policy owner	Human Resources Department
Applies to	All permanent full-time employees

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1. Purpose

This policy sets out the types of leave available to employees of XYZ Company, how leave is earned and used, and how it is requested and approved. It aims to give employees time to rest and attend to personal matters while keeping operations running smoothly.

2. Scope and Eligibility

2.1 This policy applies to all permanent full-time employees of XYZ Company.

2.2 Employees on probation (the first 3 months of service) may take Casual Leave and Sick Leave from their joining date. Annual Leave accrues during probation but may be taken only after confirmation.

2.3 Contract employees, part-time employees, interns and consultants are not covered by this policy. Their leave is governed by their individual contracts.

3. Leave Year

The leave year runs from **1 January to 31 December**. Leave entitlements are credited at the start of each leave year, except Annual Leave, which accrues monthly (see Section 4.1).

4. Types of Leave

4.0 Summary of Entitlements

Leave type	Entitlement	Paid	Section
Annual Leave	20 working days per year	Yes	4.1
Casual Leave	8 working days per year	Yes	4.2
Sick Leave	12 working days per year	Yes	4.3
Maternity Leave	16 weeks per child	Yes	4.4
Paternity Leave	7 calendar days per child	Yes	4.5
Marriage Leave	5 working days, once during employment	Yes	4.6
Bereavement Leave	Up to 5 working days	Yes	4.7
Compensatory Off	1 day for each qualifying day worked	Yes	4.8

4.1 Annual Leave

(a) Employees earn Annual Leave at the rate of 1.67 working days per month of service, totalling 20 working days in a full leave year.

(b) Annual Leave of 3 or more consecutive working days must be requested at least 7 calendar days in advance.

(c) A single period of Annual Leave may not exceed 10 consecutive working days without the written approval of the Department Head.

(d) Up to **10 unused days** may be carried forward to the next leave year. Carried-forward days must be used by **31 March**, after which they lapse.

(e) Annual Leave cannot be encashed while the employee is in service. On separation, any unused Annual Leave balance is paid at the rate of basic salary divided by 30 per day.

4.2 Casual Leave

(a) Casual Leave is for short, unplanned personal needs.

(b) No more than **3 consecutive working days** of Casual Leave may be taken at one time.

(c) Casual Leave may not be combined with Annual Leave.

(d) Unused Casual Leave lapses at the end of the leave year and cannot be carried forward or encashed.

4.3 Sick Leave

(a) Employees must inform their line manager of a sick absence **by 10:00 AM** on the first day of absence.

(b) A medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner is required if the sick absence is **more than 2 consecutive working days**.

(c) Unused Sick Leave lapses at the end of the leave year and cannot be carried forward or encashed.

(d) If the Sick Leave balance is exhausted, the employee may, with line manager approval, use Annual Leave for further sick absence. Otherwise, the absence is treated as Leave Without Pay (see Section 8).

4.4 Maternity Leave

(a) Female employees who have completed at least **6 months** of service are entitled to **16 weeks** of paid Maternity Leave for each child.

(b) Employees should notify HR in writing at least **8 weeks** before the expected date of delivery and provide a medical certificate confirming the expected date.

(c) Up to 8 weeks of the leave may be taken before the expected date of delivery. The remainder is taken after delivery.

(d) Maternity Leave is not deducted from any other leave balance.

4.5 Paternity Leave

(a) Confirmed male employees are entitled to **7 consecutive calendar days** of paid Paternity Leave for each child, up to two children during employment.

(b) Paternity Leave must be taken within **30 days** of the birth of the child.

(c) The employee must provide a copy of the birth certificate or hospital discharge document to HR.

4.6 Marriage Leave

(a) Confirmed employees are entitled to **5 working days** of paid Marriage Leave, available **once** during their employment.

(b) Marriage Leave must be requested at least **14 calendar days** in advance and taken within 30 days either side of the wedding date.

(c) An invitation card or marriage certificate must be provided to HR as evidence.

4.7 Bereavement Leave

(a) Upon the death of an **immediate family member** (spouse, child, parent, sibling), an employee is entitled to up to **5 working days** of paid leave.

(b) Upon the death of an **extended family member** (grandparent, parent-in-law, aunt, uncle), an employee is entitled to up to **2 working days** of paid leave.

(c) Bereavement Leave may be taken without advance notice. The employee should inform the line manager as soon as possible.

4.8 Compensatory Off

(a) An employee who is asked to work on a weekly holiday or public holiday, with prior written approval from the line manager, earns **1 day** of Compensatory Off for each day worked.

(b) Compensatory Off must be taken within **60 calendar days** of the day worked. After this period, it lapses.

(c) Compensatory Off cannot be encashed.

5. Weekly Holidays and Public Holidays

5.1 The weekly holidays at XYZ Company are **Friday and Saturday**.

5.2 The list of public holidays for each year is published by HR in December of the previous year.

5.3 Weekly holidays and public holidays that fall within a continuous period of Annual Leave are **not counted** as leave days.

6. Applying for Leave

6.1 All leave must be requested through the **PeopleHub** employee portal, except where this policy allows leave to be reported by phone or message (for example, Sick Leave or Bereavement Leave). In such cases the employee must submit the request in PeopleHub within **2 working days** of returning to work.

6.2 The line manager must approve or reject a leave request within **2 working days** of submission. Rejections must include a reason.

6.3 Leave is subject to business needs. A line manager may ask an employee to change the dates of Annual Leave, but may not refuse Sick Leave, Maternity Leave, Paternity Leave or Bereavement Leave that meets the conditions of this policy.

6.4 If a request is not acted on within 2 working days, the employee may escalate it to the HR Department.

7. Leave During Notice Period

Annual Leave and Casual Leave may not be taken during an employee's notice period unless approved in writing by the Department Head and HR.

8. Leave Without Pay and Unauthorised Absence

8.1 Absence from work that is not covered by an available leave balance, or that has not been approved, is treated as **Leave Without Pay (LWP)**. Pay for each LWP day is deducted at the rate of basic salary divided by 30.

8.2 An employee who is absent without approval or notification for more than **3 consecutive working days** will receive a show-cause notice from HR.

8.3 An employee who is absent without approval or notification for **10 consecutive working days** or more may be treated as having abandoned their employment, following due process.

9. Confidentiality of Leave Records

9.1 Leave records and the reasons for leave, including medical information, are **confidential**.

9.2 Leave records may be accessed only by the employee concerned, their line manager (for approval and planning purposes), and authorised HR staff.

9.3 Employees must not request, and managers and HR staff must not disclose, another employee's leave balance, medical information or reason for leave to anyone who is not authorised under this policy.

10. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Plan leave in advance, submit requests in PeopleHub, and provide required documents.
Line manager	Review and decide on requests within 2 working days and keep team coverage in place.
HR Department	Maintain leave records, publish the holiday calendar, and answer questions about this policy.

11. Policy Review and Contact

11.1 This policy is reviewed once a year by the HR Department. Changes take effect only after they are approved by the Managing Director and communicated to all employees.

11.2 For any question about this policy, employees should contact the HR Department at **hr@xyz-company.example**.

End of policy. HR-POL-004, Version 2.0.